



**California State University, Long Beach
1250 Bellflower Boulevard, Long Beach, CA 90840
CSU-Louis Stokes Alliance for Minority Participation (LSAMP)
National Science Foundation (NSF HRD- 1302873)**

May 10, 2021

Dear Alex,

Congratulations! You have been accepted into the Louis Stokes Alliance for Minority Participation (LSAMP) 2021 Academic Year (AY) Fellows Program. This program is sponsored by the California State University (CSU) Alliance and the National Science Foundation (HRD- 1302873) and is designed to assist students who wish to pursue a graduate degree and career in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics).

It is our pleasure to invite you to participate in this year-long research education program along with a cadre of talented and diverse student researchers selected from a very competitive applicant pool.

Here are some details for the AY research program:

Goal: The goal of the AY research program is to provide a year-long research experience in the STEM field in a mentored environment with a faculty member from CSULB. You are required to participate in research activity as directed by the faculty mentor and in monthly meetings or workshops focused on professional development activities and responsible conduct of research during the academic year.

Length and duration: The 2021-2022 LSAMP academic year research program spans over Fall 2021 and Spring 2022 semesters (08/17/21-05/20/22). However, the program expects you to complete a few program-specific requirements during summer 2021 (Responsible Conduct of Research CITI online and 4 face to face training sessions). We also highly recommend that you participate in summer 2021 professional development workshop activities and work on your research project during summer 2021 and winter/spring breaks in consultation with your research mentor.

Research experience:

Faculty mentor: You are expected to have identified a faculty member who is willing to serve as a research mentor before the start of the AY program. *This is a mandatory requirement.* The LSAMP Program Director may be able to assist you in identifying a mentor if needed. The mentor is responsible for all aspects of the research experience for the participant. The faculty mentor may identify a graduate student or an experienced undergraduate for day-to-day assistance in the lab or the field for the participant.

Research hours: LSAMP Fellows are expected to work 8-10 hours per week each semester. The faculty mentor will determine the hours spent by the program participant in the research lab or fieldwork.

Due to the COVID-19 pandemic and restricted in-person activity, the program will defer the nature of the activities (in-person or online or hybrid) to the mentor. If the mentor opts to carry out in-person research or fieldwork, the participant must be included in the faculty's lab or field research recovery protocol as approved by participant mentor's college. Mentors must provide proof of approval from the Associate Dean of Research.

The LSAMP program will provide a stipend only for the AY program. However, participants are highly encouraged to start working on their research project during summer 2021 in consultation with the mentor and continue their research work during winter and spring breaks. Typically, LSAMP Fellows continue working with the mentor after the program ends.

Research project: The participants will participate in a defined research project that may be a collaboration or partnership with other research trainees in the research group. The participants will prepare a research proposal of their activity under the direction of their faculty mentor. Participants need to submit a *semester report* of their research progress including the research methods and findings. In addition, they are encouraged to present their research proposal and/or findings in oral or poster format on campus or at regional, national or international conferences.

Professional development activities: The AY research fellows are required to attend and participate in monthly meetings or workshops.

Day/time/duration: TBD (~ 1 hour)

Format: Virtual or in-person

Content: Detailed schedule of events will be shared the week before start of the program. They are designed to develop the soft skills, to enhance the research experience and include topics such as presentation and communication skills, research careers, introduction to scientific literature and critical reading.

Responsible Conduct of Research: AY research fellows are required to complete the online CITI training on responsible conduct of research (details will be shared the week before start of the program), and 8 hours of faculty-led discussions.

Funds: Funds have been set aside to be dispersed as:

Stipend: AY research program participants will receive \$ 1700.00 (*contingent upon funding*) issued pending satisfactory completion of requirements, including the workshops on responsible conduct of research. They will be required to keep a log of their hours (LSAMP lab logs), and submit a record of this log, approved by their faculty mentor, in order to receive final payment.

Lab/Research Supplies: The faculty mentors will receive \$ 400 to be spent for research supplies or fieldwork or for items needed to carry out the research project. Please consult with program personnel for allowability of expenses.

Textbook reimbursement and academic supplies: Some funds are available for reimbursing purchase of textbook and other academic supplies (Please consult with program personnel for allowability of expenses).

Travel expense for conference presentation: Limited funds are available for participants travel to conference for presentation of scientific findings (Please consult with program personnel for details).

Acceptance/Agreement: If you accept this offer from the LSAMP AY research program, please email back to us: (i) completed *Student Agreement form* and (ii) a copy of your mentor's campus approval letter by **Mon, May 24, 2021**. If you have any changes in your plans, please let us as soon as possible to allow us time to place an alternate student in your position.

We again congratulate you on the honor of being selected for this competitive research program. We are excited to support you in the academic progression and professional development of your chosen STEM field. If you have any questions regarding this program, please do not hesitate to contact us.

We look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Vas

Vasanthi Narayanaswami, Ph.D., FAHA
Faculty Director, LSAMP
California State University, Long Beach